The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: August 2026. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at $68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

August 2026 Locked August 2026 is locked (closed 2 Sep 2026). These numbers won't change.

In short: Jobs made a 47.2% gross margin in August: maintenance contracts the most (63.9%), installations the least (40.8%).

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

August's jobs made $94,153 gross margin (47.2%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $27,812 and overheads $59,500, leaving $6,841 profit before tax (3.4% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 43.8% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$94,153
Technician wages and on-costs	$72,352
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$44,540
Technician time not charged to jobs	$27,812
Gross profit (the P&L)	$66,341
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$59,500
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$6,841
Revenue	$199,523
Gross margin on jobs, %	47.2%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	3.4%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**43.8%**

Type of job: All jobs

Job gross margin, August · All jobs
47.2%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, July · All jobs
43.4%
target 35.0%

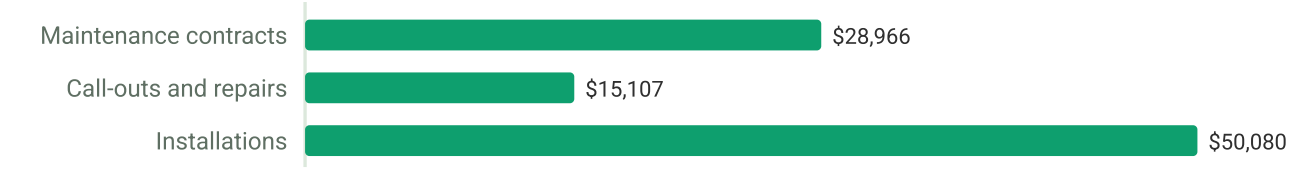
Gross margin jobs need to break even
43.8%
covers overheads and time not charged (August)

Job gross margin by type of job, August 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

In August maintenance contracts made a 63.9% job gross margin, installations made a 40.8% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 48.2% job gross margin (technician time at $68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 43.8% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 40.8% gross margin, 5.8 points over the 35.0% target ($7,100 ahead on $122,800 in August). Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($13,094 ahead on $45,350 in August).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

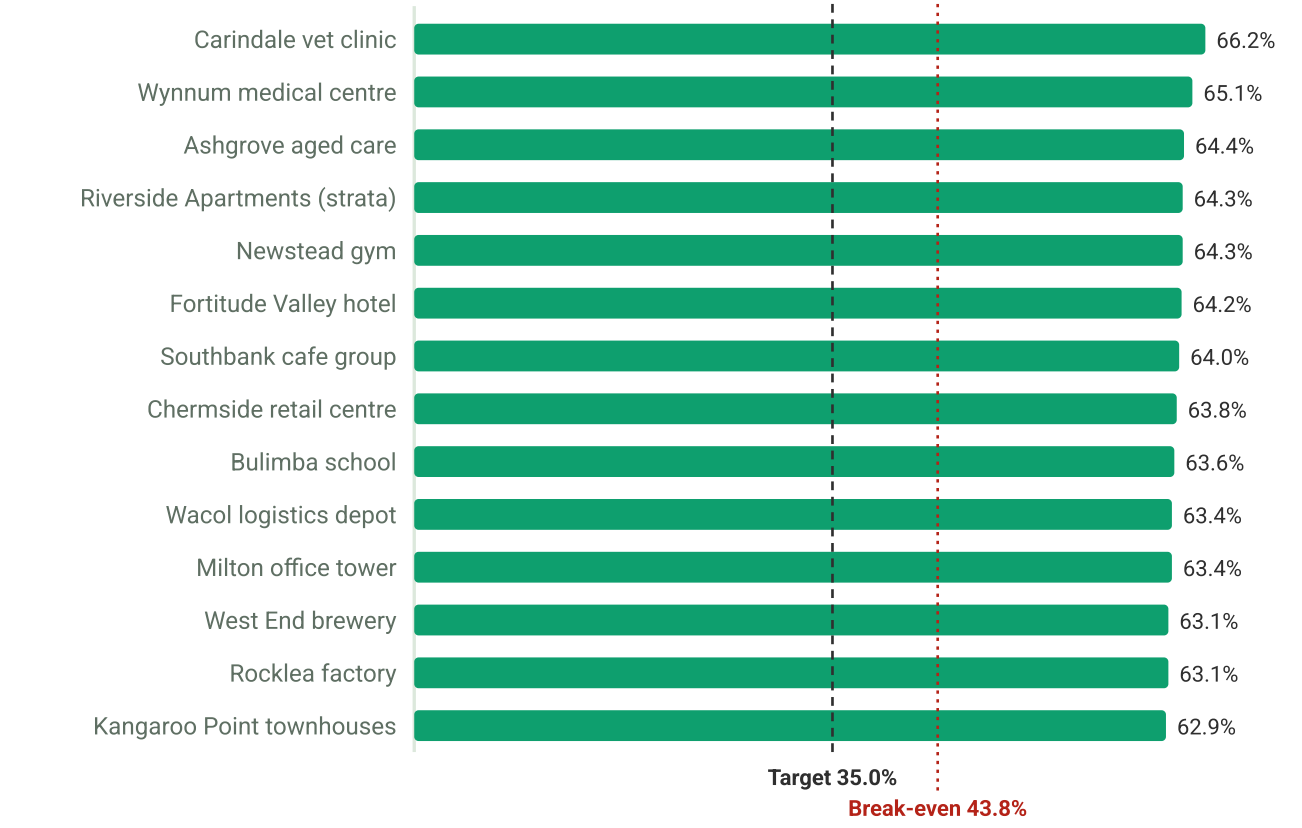
Job gross margin, August · Maintenance contracts
63.9%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, July · Maintenance contracts
63.9%
target 35.0%

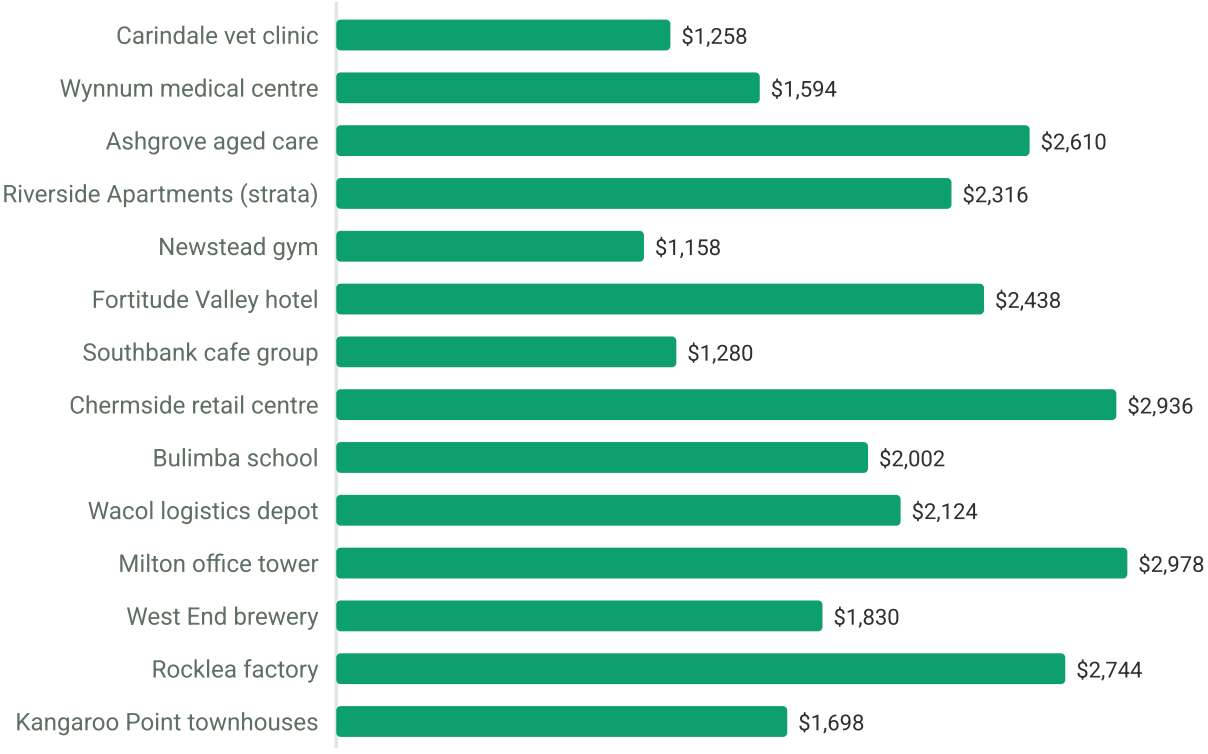
Gross margin jobs need to break even
43.8%
covers overheads and time not charged (August)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, August 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

All 14 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 62.9% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a $2,700 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 62.9% gross margin, 27.9 points over the 35.0% target ($753 ahead on $2,700 in August). All maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($13,094 ahead on $45,350 in August).

Type of job: Installations

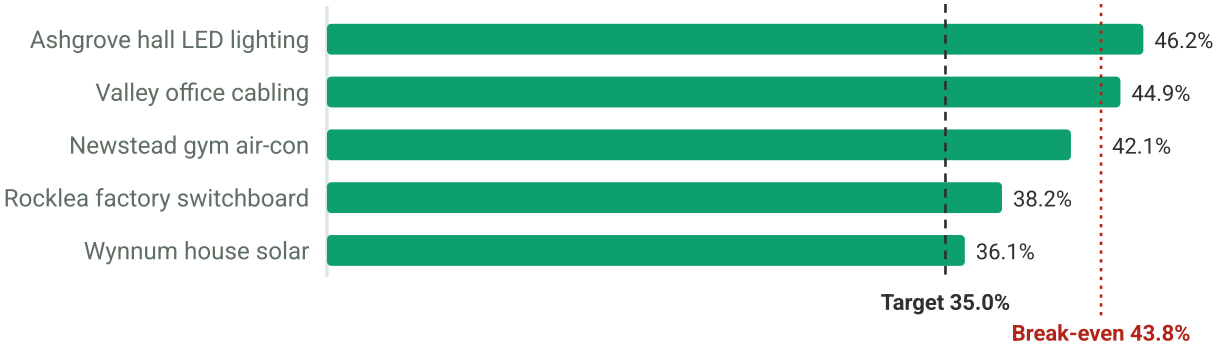
Job gross margin, August · Installations
40.8%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, July · Installations
36.0%
target 35.0%

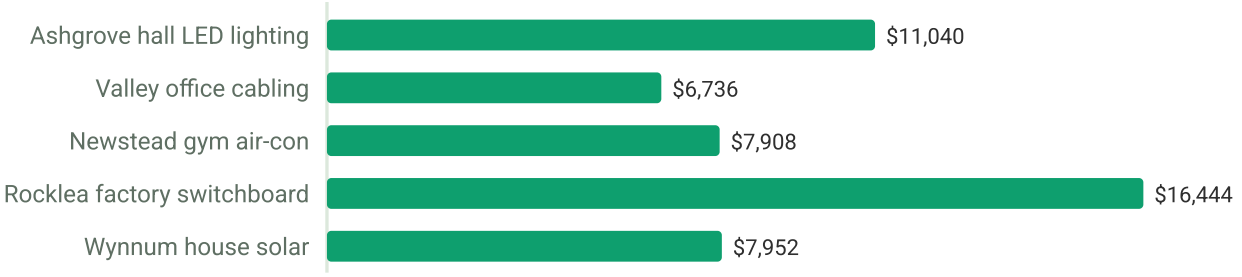
Gross margin jobs need to break even
43.8%
covers overheads and time not charged (August)

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in August 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

0 of the 5 installation jobs invoiced in August made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Wynnum house solar made a 36.1% job gross margin: 36.0 h of technician time ($2,448) and $2,200 of subcontractors on a $22,000 job. Jobs need 43.8% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Every installation cleared the 35.0% target. Most profitable: Ashgrove hall LED lighting (46.2%).

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

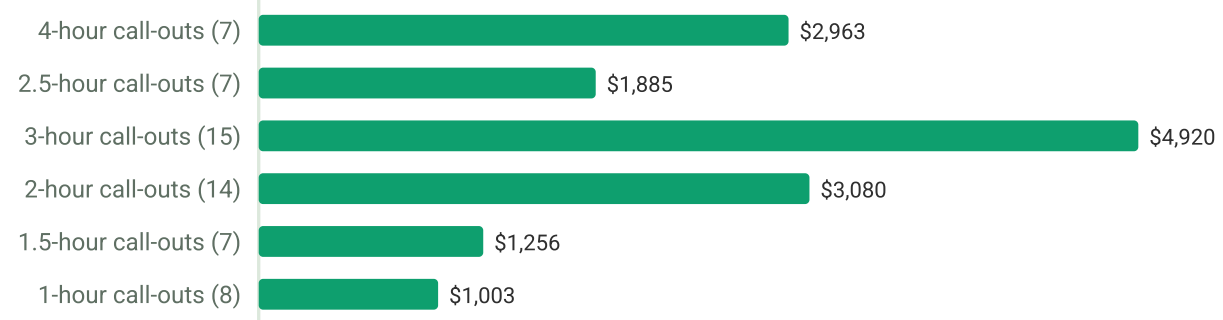
Job gross margin, August · Call-outs and repairs	Job gross margin, July · Call-outs and repairs	Gross margin jobs need to break even	Technician time charged, August	Materials charged, August
48.2%	**47.8%**	**43.8%**	**$22,338**	**$9,035**
target 35.0%	target 35.0%	covers overheads and time not charged (August)	71.2% of call-out revenue	$6,950 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, August 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

58 call-outs in August billed $22,338 of technician time and $9,035 of materials ($6,950 at cost plus 30%), and made a 48.2% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 42.6% to 50.4% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

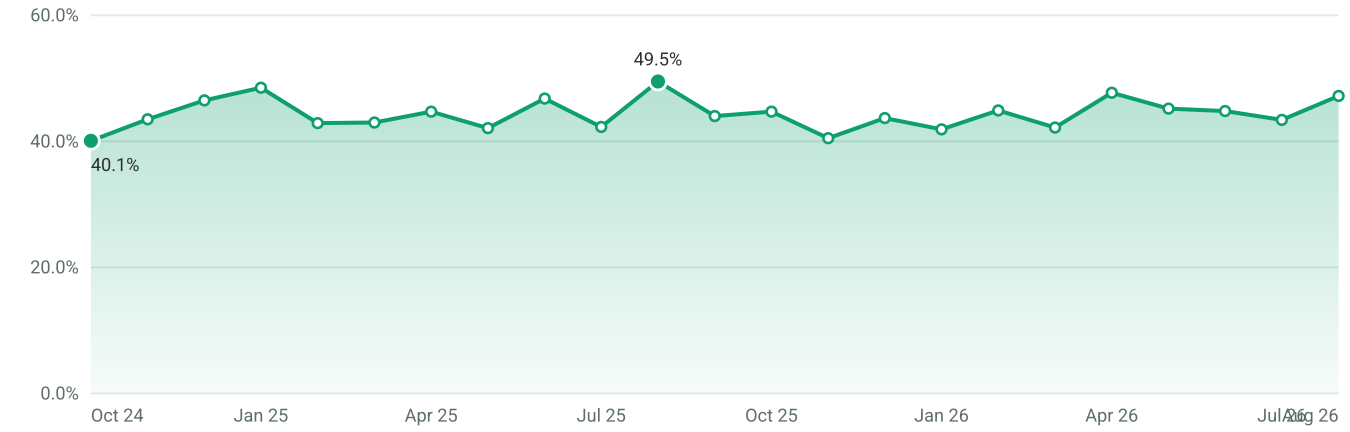
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 48.2% gross margin, 13.2 points over the 35.0% target ($4,126 ahead on $31,373 in August).

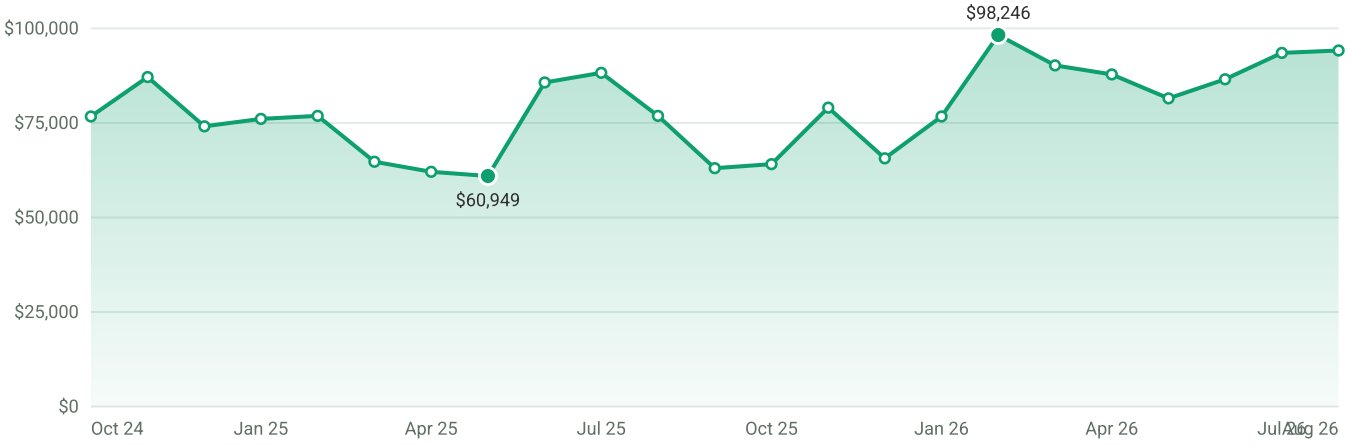
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin $



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.